PES University · Department of Computer Science and Engineering

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Research Atlas

See how an idea travelled: a map of research papers, their citations, topics and lineage

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Repository: `github.com/DBS13062006/research-atlas`

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1. Abstract

Research Atlas is a research-discovery platform built on two databases. PostgreSQL 18 is the system of record for 5,761 real papers in six themes (spiking networks, transformers, graph learning, vision, clinical machine learning and reinforcement learning), their 77,024 in-corpus citations, 24,736 authors, the four-level OpenAlex topic hierarchy, methods and datasets from the Papers with Code archive, and 33 Retraction Watch records. Its rules live in the database: 125 named constraints, 18 functions, 8 procedures, 30 triggers (11 trigger functions), 3 views and 2 materialized views, and role-based access with forced row-level security, so every request runs under the caller's own PostgreSQL role. Neo4j 2026.09 holds the same catalog as a knowledge graph, fed by a transactional outbox, with a 768-dimension vector index over local EmbeddingGemma embeddings, graph algorithms (ArticleRank, Leiden, betweenness), and two graph-native features with full read, update and delete: reading trails and curated relations. A Next.js 16.4 application and a 66-endpoint REST API are the only way in. A Query Lab runs every catalog query, DML statement, constraint proof, routine and trigger demo live, with plans. 361 pgTAP tests, 327 Vitest tests and 67 browser tests verify it.

2. Problem and objectives

Problem

A researcher entering a field faces thousands of papers and no map. Search engines answer “which papers mention X”, but not the questions that matter when learning a field: where did this idea come from, what did it lead to, how are two papers connected, which work is quietly influential, and does anything I rely on lean on retracted research?

Research Atlas answers those questions over a real corpus of 5,761 papers (spiking neural networks, transformers, graph learning, vision, clinical machine learning and reinforcement learning) with their 77,024 in-corpus citations, 24,736 authors, the OpenAlex topic hierarchy, methods and datasets from the Papers with Code archive, and 33 Retraction Watch records.

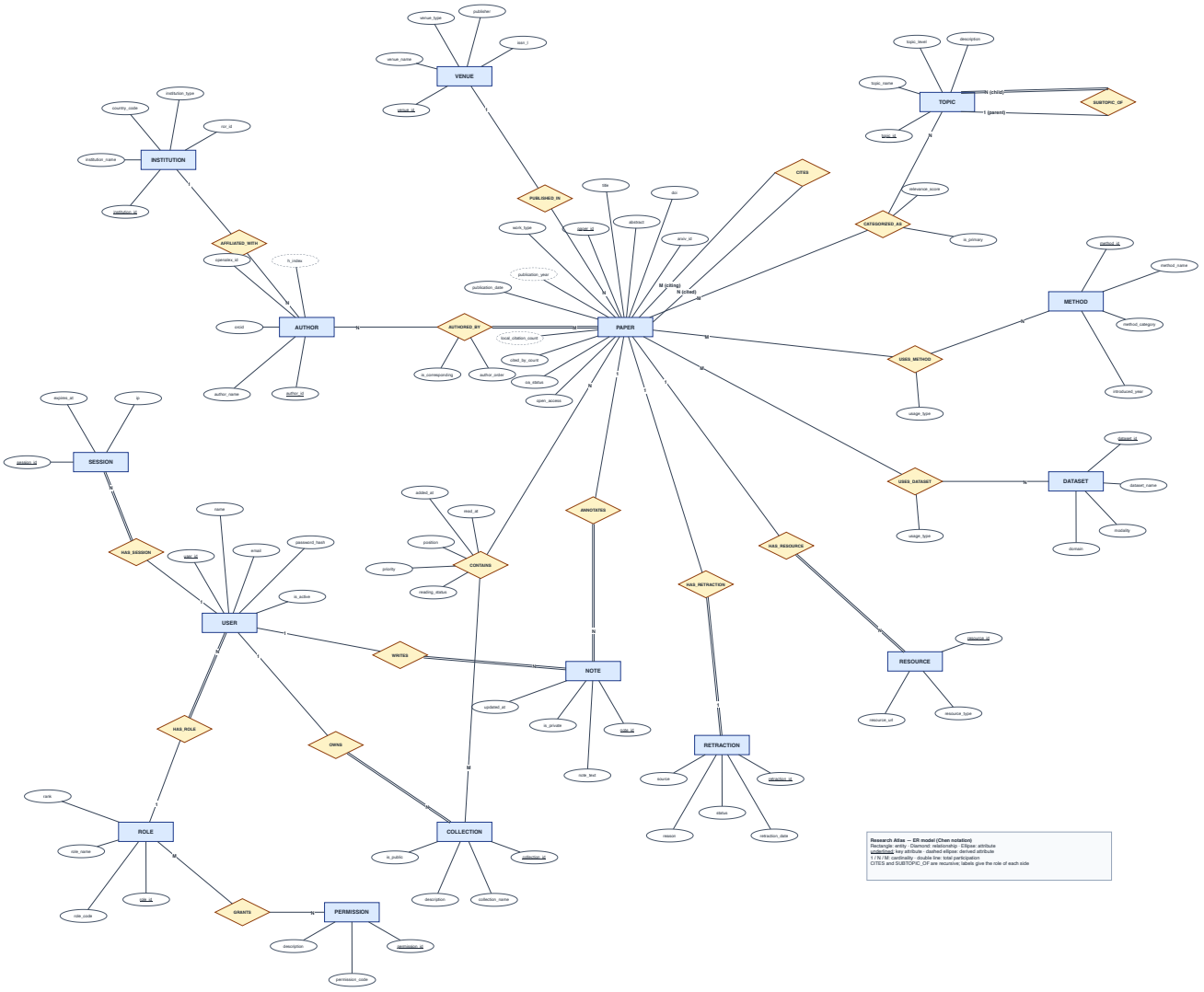
Objectives

1. Model the domain properly: a Chen ER model mapped to a BCNF relational schema in which every rule is a named constraint or trigger.
2. Exercise the full range of SQL: DDL with constraints, every DML form, joins, nested and correlated subqueries, recursive CTEs, analytics, procedures, functions, triggers and views.
3. Enforce authentication and role-based access **inside PostgreSQL**, with GRANTs and row-level security, not only in application code.
4. Add a NoSQL and vector store that does what SQL does poorly — graph algorithms, vector search, graph-native data — and keep it consistent without dual writes.
5. Build a usable, accessible application and API over both, and prove everything with automated tests.

Use cases

#	Use case	Actor	Main flow	Database features exercised
UC1	Find papers	Anyone	Type a query; compare lexical, semantic and hybrid rankings	full-text search (`fn_search_papers`), Neo4j vector index, Reciprocal Rank Fusion
UC2	Trace an idea	Anyone	Pick a paper; see what it builds on and what built on it, by year and hop	recursive CTE with `SEARCH` / `CYCLE` (`fn_paper_lineage`); Cypher variable-length path
UC3	Connect two papers	Anyone	Pick two papers; see the shortest citation chain	breadth-first recursive CTE with a path array; Cypher `SHORTEST`
UC4	Explore a field	Anyone	Browse domain → field → subfield → topic; growth per year	self-referencing table, recursive CTE, `fn_topic_growth` , materialized views
UC5	Spot research fronts and hidden gems	Anyone	Ranked communities and under-cited influential papers	Graph Data Science: Leiden, ArticleRank
UC6	Check integrity	Anyone / researcher	See retracted papers and what cites them within two hops; check one's own library	recursive CTE, `v_retraction_exposure` , RLS-scoped query
UC7	Sign up and sign in	Visitor	Create an account; sign in; lockout after five failures	`sp_register_user` , Argon2id, hashed session tokens, `SECURITY DEFINER` auth functions
UC8	Organise reading	Researcher	Collections as boards (Not read, Reading, Read), priorities, notes	RLS on collections and notes, triggers stamping `read_at` , `sp_add_to_collection`
UC9	Curate relations and trails	Researcher	Assert “A extends B”; build an ordered reading trail	graph-native data in Neo4j with full read, update and delete
UC10	Keep the catalog right	Curator	Import by DOI; correct metadata; link methods and datasets; moderate relations	`sp_import_paper` (MERGE), CHECK constraints, audit and outbox triggers
UC11	Run the atlas	Administrator	Change roles, deactivate users, read the audit trail, sync the graph, refresh analytics	`sp_set_user_role` , last-admin trigger, partitioned `audit_log` , `pg_stat_statements`
UC12	Inspect the database live	Researcher and up	Run any catalog query, DML, constraint proof, routine or trigger demo; see plans and side effects	Query Lab: role-scoped execution, `EXPLAIN ANALYZE` , `fn_lab_side_effects` , Cypher `PROFILE`

3. ER diagram (rubric 1)



Relationships

Relationship	Entities	Cardinality	Participation	Attributes	Why
AFFILIATED_WITH	AUTHOR – INSTITUTION	N : 1	partial both	—	An author's current institution may be unknown
PUBLISHED_IN	PAPER – VENUE	N : 1	partial both	—	Preprints may have no venue
AUTHORED_BY	PAPER – AUTHOR	M : N	total on PAPER	author_order, is_corresponding	Every paper has at least one author; position matters
CITES (recursive)	PAPER – PAPER	M : N	partial	—	Roles *citing* and *cited*; a paper cannot cite itself
CATEGORIZED_AS	PAPER – TOPIC	M : N	partial	relevance_score, is_primary	OpenAlex scores each topic
SUBTOPIC_OF (recursive)	TOPIC – TOPIC	N : 1	total on non-root child	—	Only domains (level 0) have no parent
USES_METHOD	PAPER – METHOD	M : N	partial	usage_type	Proposed, used, compared, extended, baseline
USES_DATASET	PAPER – DATASET	M : N	partial	usage_type	Training, validation, testing, benchmarking
HAS_RESOURCE	PAPER – RESOURCE	1 : N	total on RESOURCE	—	A resource without a paper is meaningless
HAS_RETRACTION	PAPER – RETRACTION	1 : 0..1	total on RETRACTION	—	One retraction record per paper at most

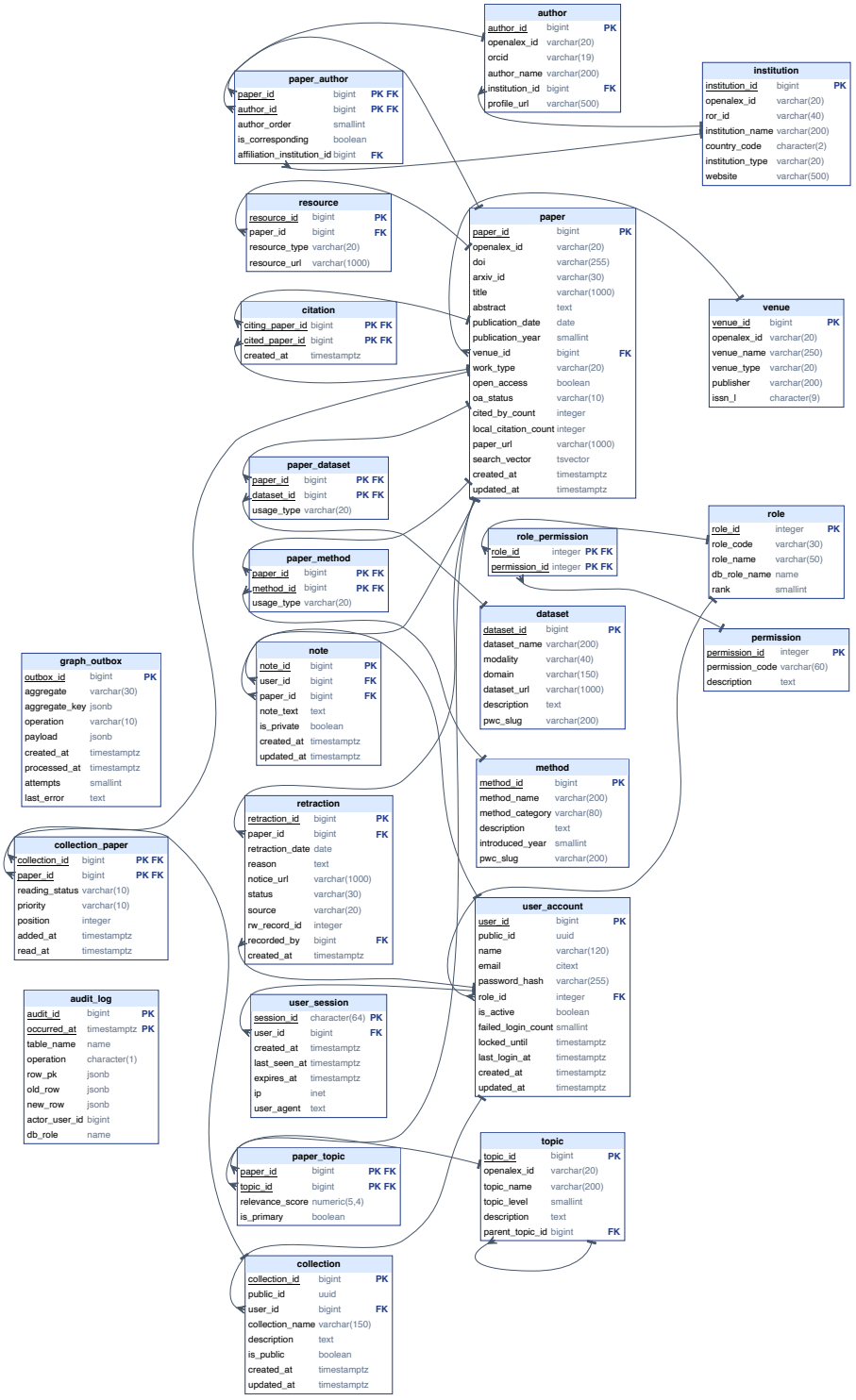
Relationship	Entities	Cardinality	Participation	Attributes	Why
HAS_ROLE	USER – ROLE	N : 1	total on USER	—	Every account has exactly one role
GRANTS	ROLE – PERMISSION	M : N	partial	—	The permission matrix
HAS_SESSION	USER – SESSION	1 : N	total on SESSION	—	Several devices at once
OWNS	USER – COLLECTION	1 : N	total on COLLECTION	—	Collections belong to someone
CONTAINS	COLLECTION – PAPER	M : N	partial	reading_status, priority, position, added_at, read_at	The Kanban board
WRITES	USER – NOTE	1 : N	total on NOTE	—	
ANNOTATES	NOTE – PAPER	N : 1	total on NOTE	—	A note is always about one paper

Cardinality and participation decisions

- **AUTHORED_BY is total on PAPER** but not on AUTHOR: an author record can outlive its last paper (for example after a merge), while a paper without authors is a data error. The database enforces the paper side when papers are imported through `sp_import_paper`.
- **CITES is M:N and recursive.** The two roles become `citing_paper_id` and `cited_paper_id` in the relational schema, and `chk_no_self_citation` forbids the reflexive case.
- **SUBTOPIC_OF is total on non-root children.** A CHECK constraint ties the parent to the level (`chk_topic_only_domains_are_roots`) and a trigger refuses cycles and level inversions.
- **HAS_RETRACTION is 1 : 0..1**, which becomes a foreign key plus `UNIQUE (paper_id)` on `retraction`.
- **Derived attributes** are drawn dashed. `publication_year` is a virtual generated column; `local_citation_count` is kept exact by a statement-level trigger; `h_index` is computed by `fn_author_h_index` and cached in a materialized view. Chapter 4 explains why these two stored values do not break normal form.

4. Relational schema (rubric 2)

The 15 entities and 17 relationships map to 24 tables: 22 domain tables plus `audit_log` and `graph_outbox`. The diagram below is generated from the live database.



Mapping rules used

ER construct	Relational mapping	Example
Strong entity	Table with a surrogate `BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY` key	`paper(paper_id)`
N:1 relationship	Foreign key on the N side	`paper.venue_id → venue`
1:N relationship with total participation on N	`NOT NULL` foreign key on the N side	`resource.paper_id NOT NULL`
1:0..1 relationship	Foreign key plus `UNIQUE`	`retraction.paper_id UNIQUE`
M:N relationship	Link table whose primary key is both foreign keys; relationship attributes become columns	`paper_author(paper_id, author_id, author_order, …)`

ER construct	Relational mapping	Example
Recursive M:N (CITES)	Link table with two foreign keys to the same table and role-named columns	`citation(citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id)`
Recursive N:1 (SUBTOPIC_OF)	Self-referencing foreign key	`topic.parent_topic_id → topic`
Derived attribute	Generated column or trigger-maintained column	`paper.publication_year` (VIRTUAL), `paper.local_citation_count` (trigger)

Keys

- **Surrogate keys everywhere.** `GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY` (SQL standard) instead of `SERIAL`: the sequence belongs to the column, and a client cannot accidentally insert its own id without `OVERRIDING SYSTEM VALUE`.
- **Natural keys kept as alternate keys.** `doi`, `openalex_id`, `arxiv_id`, `orcid`, `ror_id`, `issn_l` are each `UNIQUE` and nullable, because a paper may lack a DOI but two papers may never share one.
- **Public identifiers.** `user_account.public_id` and `collection.public_id` are `uuidv7()` values (PostgreSQL 18). They appear in URLs instead of sequential ids, which would leak how many users exist; v7 UUIDs are time-ordered, so their B-tree index stays compact.
- **Composite keys on link tables.** `paper_author(paper_id, author_id)`, `citation(citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id)`, `collection_paper(collection_id, paper_id)` and so on: a pair can appear only once.
- **Second candidate key.** `paper_author(paper_id, author_order)` is also unique (`uq_paper_author_order`), declared `DEFERRABLE INITIALLY IMMEDIATE` so two authors can swap positions in one transaction.

Delete rules

Situation	Rule	Reason
A paper is deleted	`CASCADE` to authorships, citations, topic/method/dataset links, resources, retraction, notes, collection entries	These facts mean nothing without the paper
A shared catalog row (author, topic, method, dataset) is still referenced	`RESTRICT` (SQLSTATE 23001)	Silently losing curated links is worse than an error; admins merge duplicates with `sp_merge_authors`
A venue or institution is deleted	`SET NULL`	The paper or author stays valid without it
A user is deleted	`CASCADE` to sessions, collections, notes; `SET NULL` on `retraction.recorded_by`	Personal data goes; integrity records stay
A role still has users	`RESTRICT`	Every user must keep a valid role

5. Normalization

Method

1. Atomic values only (1NF): no column stores a list. Authors, topics, methods and datasets of a paper live in link tables, not in comma-separated text.
2. For each table, write down the FDs implied by the real-world rules, not just by the keys.
3. Confirm every determinant is a superkey (BCNF ⇒ 3NF ⇒ 2NF).

Every table

Table	Candidate keys	Non-trivial FDs (determinant → dependents)	BCNF
role	{role_id}, {role_code}, {role_name}, {db_role_name}, {rank}	each key → all other columns	✓
permission	{permission_id}, {permission_code}	key → description	✓
role_permission	{role_id, permission_id}	none (all-key)	✓
user_account	{user_id}, {public_id}, {email}	key → name, password_hash, role_id, flags, timestamps	✓
user_session	{session_id}	session_id → user_id, timestamps, ip, user_agent	✓
institution	{institution_id}, {openalex_id}, {ror_id}	key → name, country_code, type, website	✓
author	{author_id}, {openalex_id}, {orcid}	key → author_name, institution_id, profile_url	✓

Table	Candidate keys	Non-trivial FDs (determinant → dependents)	BCNF
venue	{venue_id}, {openalex_id}, {issn_l}	key → venue_name, venue_type, publisher	✓
paper	{paper_id}, {openalex_id}, {doi}, {arxiv_id}	key → title, abstract, dates, venue_id, OA fields, counts	✓*
paper_author	{paper_id, author_id}, {paper_id, author_order}	see 4.2	✓
citation	{citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id}	key → created_at	✓
topic	{topic_id}, {openalex_id}, {parent_topic_id, topic_name}	key → level, description	✓
paper_topic	{paper_id, topic_id}	key → relevance_score, is_primary	✓
method	{method_id}, {method_name}, {pwc_slug}	key → category, description, introduced_year	✓
paper_method	{paper_id, method_id}	key → usage_type	✓
dataset	{dataset_id}, {dataset_name}, {pwc_slug}	key → modality, domain, url, description	✓
paper_dataset	{paper_id, dataset_id}	key → usage_type	✓
resource	{resource_id}, {paper_id, resource_type, resource_url}	resource_id → paper_id, type, url	✓
retraction	{retraction_id}, {paper_id}, {rw_record_id}	key → date, reason, notice, status, source, recorded_by	✓
collection	{collection_id}, {public_id}, {user_id, collection_name}	key → description, is_public, timestamps	✓
collection_paper	{collection_id, paper_id}	key → reading_status, priority, position, added_at, read_at	✓
note	{note_id}	note_id → user_id, paper_id, text, flags, timestamps	✓
audit_log	{audit_id, occurred_at}	key → table_name, operation, row images, actor, db_role	✓
graph_outbox	{outbox_id}	outbox_id → aggregate, key, operation, payload, status	✓

* apart from the two derived columns below.

`collection_paper.read_at` and `reading_status` look dependent on each other, but neither determines the other's value (a READ entry can have any timestamp), so there is no FD between them; the CHECK `chk_collection_paper_read_at_matches_status` only constrains which combinations are legal.

The two deliberate denormalizations

Column	Derived from	Why store it	How drift is prevented
`paper.local_citation_count`	`count(*)` of `citation` rows citing the paper	Ranking and list pages sort by it on every request; counting thousands of citation rows per page would be wasteful	Statement-level triggers on `citation` with transition tables update it once per statement, inside the same transaction
`paper.search_vector`	`title` and `abstract`	Full-text search needs an indexed `tsvector`	`GENERATED ALWAYS AS (…) STORED`: the database recomputes it on every write; it cannot be written directly

`paper.publication_year` is also derived, but it is a `VIRTUAL` generated column (PostgreSQL 18): it is computed on read and never stored, so it introduces no redundancy at all.

6. DDL with constraints (rubric 3)

Migrations

Migration	Purpose
`001_extensions.sql`	Extensions used by the schema: case-insensitive email, trigram search, query statistics.
`005_owner.sql`	Database roles. ra_owner owns every schema object; later migrations switch to it with SET ROLE so ownership never sits with the superuser. BYPASSRLS lets SECURITY DEFINER functions owned by it read tables whose row-level security is FORCED. The four group roles form the application privilege ladder; their grants live in 300_rbac. Roles are cluster-wide, so creation is idempotent (the test database shares the cluster).
`010_rbac_tables.sql`	Access-control and account tables.
`020_catalog_tables.sql`	The research catalog: institutions, authors, venues, papers and everything linked to them.
`030_user_content_tables.sql`	Content owned by individual users: collections, their papers, and notes.
`040_system_tables.sql`	System tables: the partitioned audit trail and the transactional outbox that feeds Neo4j.

Migration	Purpose
`050_indexes.sql`	Indexes beyond keys. PostgreSQL does not index foreign-key columns automatically; every FK not led by a primary key gets one so joins and ON DELETE checks stay fast.
`200_functions.sql`	Functions. Each one exists because a feature needs it; see docs/08-advanced-sql.md.
`210_procedures.sql`	Stored procedures. Business operations that must happen as one unit live in the database, so every client (web app, API, scripts, psql) gets the same rules.
`220_triggers.sql`	Triggers. Rules a CHECK cannot express (they read other rows or tables), derived columns, the audit trail and the outbox that keeps Neo4j in step with PostgreSQL.
`230_views.sql`	Views and materialized views. Plain views use security_invoker so row-level security is evaluated for the caller, not for the view owner.
`300_rbac.sql`	Role-based access control enforced by PostgreSQL itself.
`310_admin_stats.sql`	Administrators may read query statistics (pg_stat_statements) for every role, which the admin page uses to list the slowest queries. pg_read_all_stats is a predefined read-only role.
`320_display_names.sql`	Public display names. Trails and curated relations live in Neo4j and record only the author's user_id. user_account is behind forced RLS, so this narrow SECURITY DEFINER function returns the one column that is safe to show next to public content: the name. No email, no role.
`330_lab_side_effects.sql`	Query Lab side effects. After a lab run (always inside a transaction), the lab shows the audit_log and graph_outbox rows that the run's triggers wrote. Only administrators may read those tables, so this SECURITY DEFINER function returns exactly the rows created by the caller's own current transaction (xmin = its transaction id) and nothing older or anyone else's.
`900_reference_seed.sql`	Reference data every installation needs: the three application roles, the permission vocabulary, and which role holds which permission. Higher roles hold everything lower roles do.

Constraints, indexes and triggers

The schema has 125 named constraints, 28 secondary indexes and 30 triggers; chapter 5 of the documentation lists every one with its definition. The psql snapshot below shows one table as PostgreSQL describes it.

```
psql — researchatlas

researchatlas=# \d+ citation
                                                  Table "public.citation"
     Column      |           Type           | Collation | Nullable | Default | Storage | Compression | Stats target | Description
-----------------+--------------------------+-----------+----------+---------+---------+-------------+--------------+-------------
 citing_paper_id | bigint                   |           | not null |         | plain   |             |              |
 cited_paper_id  | bigint                   |           | not null |         | plain   |             |              |
 created_at      | timestamp with time zone |           | not null | now()   | plain   |             |              |
Indexes:
    "pk_citation" PRIMARY KEY, btree (citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id)
    "ix_citation_cited_paper_id" btree (cited_paper_id)
Check constraints:
    "chk_no_self_citation" CHECK (citing_paper_id <> cited_paper_id)
Foreign-key constraints:
    "fk_citation_cited" FOREIGN KEY (cited_paper_id) REFERENCES paper(paper_id) ON DELETE CASCADE
    "fk_citation_citing" FOREIGN KEY (citing_paper_id) REFERENCES paper(paper_id) ON DELETE CASCADE
Not-null constraints:
    "citation_citing_paper_id_not_null" NOT NULL "citing_paper_id"
    "citation_cited_paper_id_not_null" NOT NULL "cited_paper_id"
    "citation_created_at_not_null" NOT NULL "created_at"
Access method: heap
```

Triggers (30)

Table	Trigger	When	Function
author	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
citation	`trg_citation_count_del`	AFTER DELETE · statement	`fn_citation_count_del`
citation	`trg_citation_count_ins`	AFTER INSERT · statement	`fn_citation_count_ins`
citation	`trg_citation_count_upd`	AFTER UPDATE · statement	`fn_citation_count_upd`
citation	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
collection	`trg_audit`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_audit`
collection	`trg_set_updated_at`	BEFORE UPDATE · row	`fn_set_updated_at`

Table	Trigger	When	Function
collection_paper	`trg_reading_status_read_at`	BEFORE INSERT OR UPDATE · row	`fn_reading_status_read_at`
dataset	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
institution	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
method	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
note	`trg_note_owner_immutable`	BEFORE UPDATE · row	`fn_note_owner_immutable`
note	`trg_set_updated_at`	BEFORE UPDATE · row	`fn_set_updated_at`
paper	`trg_audit`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_audit`
paper	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
paper	`trg_set_updated_at`	BEFORE UPDATE · row	`fn_set_updated_at`
paper_author	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
paper_dataset	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
paper_method	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
paper_topic	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
retraction	`trg_audit`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_audit`
retraction	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
retraction	`trg_retraction_date_guard`	BEFORE INSERT OR UPDATE · row	`fn_retraction_date_guard`
role_permission	`trg_audit`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_audit`
topic	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`
topic	`trg_topic_hierarchy_guard`	BEFORE INSERT OR UPDATE · row	`fn_topic_hierarchy_guard`
user_account	`trg_audit`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_audit`
user_account	`trg_protect_last_admin`	BEFORE UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_protect_last_admin`
user_account	`trg_set_updated_at`	BEFORE UPDATE · row	`fn_set_updated_at`
venue	`trg_graph_outbox`	AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE · row	`fn_graph_outbox`

Constraint proofs

Each proof is an action the database must refuse. They run live in the Query Lab and as pgTAP tests.

P01 · A paper cites itself

Technique: CHECK constraint across two columns · **runs as** `ra_curator` · `proofs/P01_self_citation.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `paper_id` = 1

```
INSERT INTO citation (citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id) VALUES ($1, $1);
```

Refused, as intended, by `chk_no_self_citation`:

```
new row for relation "citation" violates check constraint "chk_no_self_citation"
```

P09 · A researcher tries to record a retraction

Technique: GRANT-based access control: ra_researcher has no INSERT on retraction (SQLSTATE 42501) · **runs as** `ra_researcher` · `proofs/P09_researcher_records_retraction.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `paper_id` = 1

```
INSERT INTO retraction (paper_id, retraction_date, status) VALUES ($1, CURRENT_DATE, 'RETRACTED');
```

Refused, as intended, by SQLSTATE `42501`:

```
permission denied for table retraction
```

7. NoSQL and vector database creation (rubric 4)

Graph model

Node label	Key	Count	Source
`Paper`	`paperId`	5,761	projected from `paper` (+ `embedding`, `umapX/umapY`, `articleRank`, `community`, `betweenness` written by jobs)
`Author`	`authorId`	24,736	projected from `author`
`Institution`	`institutionId`	2,941	projected
`Venue`	`venueId`	1,135	projected
`Topic`	`topicId`	1,189	projected
`Method`	`methodId`	160	projected
`Dataset`	`datasetId`	60	projected
`Trail`	`trailId` (UUID)	2	**graph-native**
`EmbeddingMeta`	`name`	1	records the embedding model

Relationship	From → to	Count	Source
`CITES`	Paper → Paper	77,024	projected from `citation`
`AUTHORED {order, isCorresponding}`	Author → Paper	34,617	projected from `paper_author`
`AFFILIATED_WITH`	Author → Institution	22,788	projected
`BELONGS_TO_TOPIC {score, isPrimary}`	Paper → Topic	17,283	projected
`SUBTOPIC_OF`	Topic → Topic	1,185	projected
`USES_METHOD`, `USES_DATASET {usage}`	Paper → Method/Dataset	10,937 / 879	projected
`PUBLISHED_IN`	Paper → Venue	5,681	projected
`COAUTHOR {papers}`	Author → Author	157,150	**derived** from AUTHORED
`SIMILAR_TO {score, model}`	Paper → Paper	56,594	**derived** from the vector index (top 10, score ≥ 0.75)
`STEP {position, annotation}`	Trail → Paper	9	**graph-native**
`EXTENDS`, `IMPROVES_UPON`, `CONTRADICTS`, `REPLICATES`, `RELATED_TO` `{relationId, note, confidence, createdBy, …}`	Paper → Paper	5	**graph-native** curated relations

Counts are from the loaded corpus on 25 October 2026.

Schema

`graph/schema.cypher` is applied by `pnpm graph:schema`. Every statement is idempotent (`IF NOT EXISTS`):

- **9 uniqueness constraints**, one per node key (they also create the lookup indexes);
- **range indexes** on `Paper.year`, `Paper.community`, `Paper.articleRank`, `Trail.ownerId`, `Topic.level`, `STEP.position`, and on `relationId` for each curated relationship type;
- **full-text indexes** on paper titles and author names;
- a **vector index** on `Paper.embedding`:

```
CREATE VECTOR INDEX paper_embedding IF NOT EXISTS
FOR (p:Paper) ON p.embedding
WITH [p.year, p.isRetracted]
OPTIONS { indexConfig: { `vector.dimensions`: 768, `vector.similarity_function`: 'cosine' } };
```

`year` and `isRetracted` are declared as filter properties, so a `SEARCH … WHERE p.year >= 2020` filters inside the index rather than after it. Embeddings are stored as `LIST<FLOAT>`: the native `VECTOR` type needs the block store format, which Neo4j Community does not offer. `SHOW INDEXES` (catalog query C01, and the Cypher Lab) lists all of them.

Keeping Neo4j consistent: the transactional outbox

Writing to two databases from the application ("dual writes") loses data whenever one write succeeds and the other fails. Instead:

1. An `AFTER INSERT OR UPDATE OR DELETE` trigger (`trg_graph_outbox`) on every projected table inserts a row into `graph_outbox` **in the same transaction** as the change, then calls `pg_notify`. If the transaction rolls back, so does the outbox row. Updates that change nothing are skipped.
2. `drainOutbox` (`src/server/graph/projection.ts`) reads pending rows in id order with `FOR UPDATE SKIP LOCKED`, groups consecutive rows of the same table and operation into one `UNWIND` batch, applies the matching Cypher, and marks them processed. A failing group records the error and stops the drain, so a later change never overtakes an earlier one.
3. The web app drains right after each write; `pnpm graph:sync` drains on demand; the admin console shows pending and failing rows and has a “Sync graph now” button.
4. Derived `COAUTHOR` edges are refreshed for exactly the authors whose authorships changed.
5. `pnpm graph:rebuild` wipes the projected part and reloads it from PostgreSQL (5.6 s), keeping graph-native data and job-owned properties. `pnpm graph:check` compares 17 counts between the two databases, the derived co-authorship included, and fails on any drift.

The model is *eventually consistent*: the graph trails PostgreSQL by at most one drain, and can always be rebuilt from it.

8. Technology justification (rubric 5)

ADR 1 · PostgreSQL 18 rather than the 19 release candidate

Context. The course is graded on SQL depth; the database must be stable for months of development and a live demo. **Options.** PostgreSQL 18 (current stable); PostgreSQL 19 (release candidate, with SQL/PGQ graph queries planned). **Decision.** PostgreSQL 18. **Consequences.** We use 18's new features where they help — `uuidv7()`, virtual generated columns, `RETURNING old.* / new.*` (D05), `MERGE … RETURNING merge_action()` (D08) — and do graph work in Neo4j instead of a release candidate's preview feature.

ADR 2 · Neo4j as the NoSQL store, rather than MongoDB or pgvector alone

Context. The NoSQL part must add capabilities the relational model lacks, with real read, update and delete. **Options.** MongoDB (documents); pgvector inside PostgreSQL; Neo4j (property graph with a native vector index and a graph-algorithms library). **Decision.** Neo4j. **Consequences.** One engine gives multi-hop traversal, `SHORTEST` paths, vector `SEARCH` with in-index filters, and ArticleRank/Leiden/ betweenness. Documents would have duplicated the relational data without adding a new kind of query, and pgvector alone would cover similarity but not the graph algorithms. The cost is a second store to keep consistent, solved with the outbox (chapter 9).

ADR 3 · SQL first, no ORM

Context. Evaluators must see the SQL. **Options.** Prisma or Drizzle; postgres.js tagged templates with migrations in plain SQL. **Decision.** postgres.js and dbmate. **Consequences.** Every query is visible SQL, parameterised by the tagged template (no string concatenation). Business rules live in the database as constraints, functions, procedures and triggers, where an ORM would have pulled them into application code.

ADR 4 · Our own session authentication rather than an auth library

Context. Authentication and role-based access are graded inside the database. **Options.** Better Auth or Auth.js; sessions written by hand following the Copenhagen Book. **Decision.** Our own: Argon2id passwords, 256-bit tokens stored as SHA-256 hashes, lockout, renewal. **Consequences.** The schema keeps our `user_account`, `role`, `permission` and `user_session` tables, the session functions are `SECURITY DEFINER` and testable in pgTAP, and every request runs under a PostgreSQL role. We own the security code, so it is covered by unit, integration and end-to-end tests.

ADR 5 · Local embeddings with Ollama rather than a paid API

Context. Semantic search needs embeddings for 5,761 papers and for every query. **Options.** A hosted embedding API; SPECTER2 (science-tuned, Python only); EmbeddingGemma through Ollama. **Decision.** Ollama `embeddinggemma`, with a Transformers.js build of the same model as a fallback. **Consequences.** No cost, no key, no data leaving the laptop; the corpus embeds in under two minutes on the GPU; results on our probe queries are on topic (chapter 9). The fallback agrees with Ollama at cosine 0.996.

9. DML (rubric 6)

Ten DML files, one per technique. Each ran as its declared role inside a transaction that was rolled back, so the outputs are real but changed nothing.

D05 · Raise a priority and show the before and after values

Technique: UPDATE ... RETURNING old.* and new.* (PostgreSQL 18) · **runs as** `ra_researcher` · `dml/D05_priority_before_after.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `collection_id` = 26

```
UPDATE collection_paper
SET priority = CASE priority WHEN 'LOW' THEN 'MEDIUM' ELSE 'HIGH' END
WHERE collection_id = $1
RETURNING paper_id, old.priority AS priority_before, new.priority AS priority_after;
```

paper_id	priority_before	priority_after
1	LOW	MEDIUM
4933	MEDIUM	HIGH
4934	HIGH	HIGH
4975	HIGH	HIGH
5021	HIGH	HIGH

7 rows; the first 5 are shown.

D07 · Delete a paper and show what cascaded

Technique: ON DELETE CASCADE across seven child tables, row counts before and after · **runs as** `ra_admin` · `dml/D07_delete_paper_cascade.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `paper_id` = 4897

```
CREATE TEMP TABLE before_counts ON COMMIT DROP AS
SELECT 'paper_author' AS child, count(*) AS n FROM paper_author WHERE paper_id = $1
UNION ALL SELECT 'citation', count(*) FROM citation WHERE $1 IN (citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id)
UNION ALL SELECT 'paper_topic', count(*) FROM paper_topic WHERE paper_id = $1
UNION ALL SELECT 'paper_method', count(*) FROM paper_method WHERE paper_id = $1
UNION ALL SELECT 'paper_dataset', count(*) FROM paper_dataset WHERE paper_id = $1
UNION ALL SELECT 'resource', count(*) FROM resource WHERE paper_id = $1
UNION ALL SELECT 'collection_paper', count(*) FROM collection_paper WHERE paper_id = $1;
DELETE FROM paper WHERE paper_id = $1;
SELECT b.child,
       b.n AS rows_before,
       CASE b.child
         WHEN 'paper_author' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM paper_author WHERE paper_id = $1)
         WHEN 'citation' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM citation WHERE $1 IN (citing_paper_id, cited_paper_id))
         WHEN 'paper_topic' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM paper_topic WHERE paper_id = $1)
         WHEN 'paper_method' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM paper_method WHERE paper_id = $1)
         WHEN 'paper_dataset' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM paper_dataset WHERE paper_id = $1)
         WHEN 'resource' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM resource WHERE paper_id = $1)
         WHEN 'collection_paper' THEN (SELECT count(*) FROM collection_paper WHERE paper_id = $1)
       END AS rows_after
FROM before_counts b;
```

child	rows_before	rows_after
paper_author	4	0
citation	852	0
paper_topic	3	0
paper_method	3	0
paper_dataset	3	0

7 rows; the first 5 are shown.

D08 · Sync a subfield's topics from a staging table

Technique: MERGE with WHEN MATCHED, WHEN NOT MATCHED and WHEN NOT MATCHED BY SOURCE, RETURNING merge_action() · **runs as** `ra_curator` · `dml/D08_merge_topics.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `subfield_id` = 5

```
CREATE TEMP TABLE topic_staging (topic_name TEXT PRIMARY KEY, description TEXT) ON COMMIT DROP;
-- The latest taxonomy keeps two existing topics (with new descriptions) and adds one new topic.
INSERT INTO topic_staging
SELECT topic_name, 'Description refreshed from the latest taxonomy'
FROM topic WHERE parent_topic_id = $1 ORDER BY topic_id LIMIT 2;
INSERT INTO topic_staging VALUES ('Neuro-symbolic Reasoning', 'Added by the latest taxonomy');
MERGE INTO topic t
USING topic_staging s
ON t.parent_topic_id = $1 AND t.topic_name = s.topic_name
WHEN MATCHED THEN
  UPDATE SET description = s.description
WHEN NOT MATCHED THEN
  INSERT (topic_name, topic_level, parent_topic_id, description) VALUES (s.topic_name, 3, $1, s.description)
WHEN NOT MATCHED BY SOURCE AND t.parent_topic_id = $1 THEN
  UPDATE SET description = 'Not in the latest taxonomy'
RETURNING merge_action() AS action, t.topic_id, t.topic_name, t.description;
```

action	topic_id	topic_name	description
UPDATE	7	Low-power high-performance VLSI design	Description refreshed from the latest taxonomy
UPDATE	8	Advanced Memory and Neural Computing	Description refreshed from the latest taxonomy
UPDATE	16	Ferroelectric and Negative Capacitance Devices	Not in the latest taxonomy
UPDATE	24	CCD and CMOS Imaging Sensors	Not in the latest taxonomy
UPDATE	68	Organic Electronics and Photovoltaics	Not in the latest taxonomy

63 rows; the first 5 are shown.

D09 · Swap two authors' positions safely

Technique: SAVEPOINT, SET CONSTRAINTS ... DEFERRED on a DEFERRABLE UNIQUE constraint, RELEASE SAVEPOINT · **runs as** `ra_curator` · `dml/D09_swap_author_order.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `paper_id` = 1

```
SAVEPOINT before_swap;
-- Positions 1 and 2 would collide halfway through; deferring the check to the end of the
-- transaction lets both rows move.
SET CONSTRAINTS uq_paper_author_order DEFERRED;
UPDATE paper_author SET author_order = 3 - author_order WHERE paper_id = $1 AND author_order IN (1, 2);
SET CONSTRAINTS uq_paper_author_order IMMEDIATE;
RELEASE SAVEPOINT before_swap;
SELECT pa.author_order, a.author_name
FROM paper_author pa JOIN author a ON a.author_id = pa.author_id
WHERE pa.paper_id = $1
ORDER BY pa.author_order;
```

author_order	author_name
1	Narayan Srinivasa
2	Mike Davies
3	Gautham N. Chinya
4	Yongqiang Cao
5	Sri Harsha Choday

19 rows; the first 5 are shown.

10. Nested, correlated, recursive and join queries (rubric 7)

Twenty-five queries: seven joins, six nested and correlated, four recursive, and analytics, set operations, JSON and search. All 25 with outputs and plans are in chapter 7 of the documentation; a representative set follows. Outputs are from the loaded corpus.

Joins

Q03 · Which methods are benchmarked on which datasets, including unpaired ones

Technique: FULL OUTER JOIN keeps methods with no dataset and datasets with no method · **runs as** `ra_anon` · `Q03_method_dataset_pairs.sql`

```
WITH used_together AS (
  SELECT pm.method_id, pd.dataset_id, count(DISTINCT pm.paper_id) AS papers
  FROM paper_method pm
  JOIN paper_dataset pd ON pd.paper_id = pm.paper_id
  GROUP BY pm.method_id, pd.dataset_id
), methods AS (
  SELECT m.method_id, m.method_name, u.dataset_id, u.papers
  FROM method m
  LEFT JOIN used_together u ON u.method_id = m.method_id
)
SELECT coalesce(methods.method_name, '— no method —') AS method,
       coalesce(d.dataset_name, '— no dataset —') AS dataset,
       coalesce(methods.papers, 0) AS papers
FROM methods
FULL OUTER JOIN dataset d ON d.dataset_id = methods.dataset_id
ORDER BY papers DESC, method, dataset;
```

method	dataset	papers
Convolution	COCO	64

method	dataset	papers
Convolution	ImageNet	61
Convolutional Neural Network	ImageNet	58
Softmax	ImageNet	58
Residual Connection	COCO	57

1168 rows; the first 5 are shown.

Plan: Sort · planning 0.10 ms · execution 2.22 ms · operators: Sort, Hash Join, Aggregate, Seq Scan on paper_method, Hash, Seq Scan on paper_dataset, Seq Scan on method, Seq Scan on dataset

Q04 · Top 3 papers in every leaf topic

Technique: CROSS JOIN LATERAL with ORDER BY ... LIMIT inside, per-group top-N · **runs as** `ra_anon` · `Q04_top3_per_topic.sql`

```
SELECT t.topic_name, top3.title, top3.cited_by_count
FROM topic t
CROSS JOIN LATERAL (
  SELECT p.title, p.cited_by_count
  FROM paper_topic pt
  JOIN paper p ON p.paper_id = pt.paper_id
  WHERE pt.topic_id = t.topic_id
  ORDER BY p.cited_by_count DESC, p.paper_id
  LIMIT 3
) AS top3
WHERE t.topic_level = 3
ORDER BY t.topic_name, top3.cited_by_count DESC;
```

topic_name	title	cited_by_count
2D Materials and Applications	Electric Field Effect in Atomically Thin Carbon Films	66784
2D Materials and Applications	Two-dimensional materials for next-generation computing technologies	1047
2D Materials and Applications	Multi-terminal memtransistors from polycrystalline monolayer molybden…	1025
3D IC and TSV technologies	Three-dimensional integration of nanotechnologies for computing and d…	865
3D IC and TSV technologies	Neurocube	342

2053 rows; the first 5 are shown.

Plan: Sort · planning 0.11 ms · execution 14.95 ms · operators: Sort, Nested Loop, Seq Scan on topic, Limit, Bitmap Heap Scan on paper_topic, Bitmap Index Scan using ix_paper_topic_topic_id, Index Scan using pk_paper

Nested and correlated

Q09 · Authors active in every year 2021-2024

Technique: relational division, double NOT EXISTS, generate_series · **runs as** `ra_anon` · `Q09_active_every_year.sql`

```
SELECT a.author_id, a.author_name
FROM author a
WHERE NOT EXISTS (
  SELECT 1 FROM generate_series(2021, 2024) AS y(yr)
  WHERE NOT EXISTS (
    SELECT 1
    FROM paper_author pa
    JOIN paper p USING (paper_id)
    WHERE pa.author_id = a.author_id
      AND p.publication_date >= make_date(y.yr, 1, 1)
      AND p.publication_date < make_date(y.yr + 1, 1, 1)))
ORDER BY a.author_name;
```

author_id	author_name
989	Bai Tao Sun

author_id	author_name
11088	Demis Hassabis
9455	Deng-Ping Fan
6958	Fahad Shahbaz Khan
991	Guangdong Zhou

29 rows; the first 5 are shown.

Plan: Sort · planning 0.13 ms · execution 61.01 ms · operators: Sort, Nested Loop, Seq Scan on author, Function Scan, Index Scan using ix_paper_author_author_id, Index Scan using pk_paper

Recursive

Q15 · What a paper builds on, three levels deep

Technique: recursive CTE with SEARCH BREADTH FIRST and CYCLE clauses, DISTINCT ON for the shortest depth · **runs as** `ra_anon` · `Q15_lineage.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `paper_id` = 60

```
WITH RECURSIVE ancestors(paper_id, depth) AS (
  SELECT c.cited_paper_id, 1 FROM citation c WHERE c.citing_paper_id = $1
  UNION ALL
  SELECT c.cited_paper_id, a.depth + 1
  FROM ancestors a JOIN citation c ON c.citing_paper_id = a.paper_id
  WHERE a.depth < 3
) SEARCH BREADTH FIRST BY paper_id SET bfs_order
  CYCLE paper_id SET is_cycle USING visit_path
SELECT DISTINCT ON (a.paper_id) a.paper_id, a.depth, p.title, p.publication_year
FROM ancestors a
JOIN paper p ON p.paper_id = a.paper_id
WHERE NOT a.is_cycle
ORDER BY a.paper_id, a.depth
LIMIT 100;
```

paper_id	depth	title	publication_year
1	2	Loihi: A Neuromorphic Manycore Processor with On-Chip Learning	2018
2	1	Training and operation of an integrated neuromorphic network based on…	2015
4	1	Memristors with diffusive dynamics as synaptic emulators for neuromor…	2016
7	2	The future of electronics based on memristive systems	2017
8	1	Organic electrochemical transistors	2018

100 rows; the first 5 are shown.

Plan: Limit · planning 0.11 ms · execution 28.18 ms · operators: Limit, Recursive Union, Index Only Scan using pk_citation, Nested Loop, WorkTable Scan, Unique, Sort, Hash Join, …

Q16 · Shortest citation path between two papers

Technique: breadth-first recursive CTE carrying a path array, stops at the first depth that reaches the target · **runs as** `ra_anon` · `Q16_shortest_citation_path.sql`

Parameters (computed from the data): `from_id` = 1, `to_id` = 4897

```
WITH RECURSIVE walk(paper_id, depth, path) AS (
  SELECT $1::BIGINT, 0, ARRAY[$1::BIGINT]
  UNION ALL
  SELECT c.cited_paper_id, w.depth + 1, w.path || c.cited_paper_id
  FROM walk w
  JOIN citation c ON c.citing_paper_id = w.paper_id
  WHERE w.depth < 4
    AND NOT c.cited_paper_id = ANY (w.path)
    AND w.paper_id <> $2
), hits AS (
  SELECT path, depth FROM walk WHERE paper_id = $2
)
SELECT h.depth AS hops,
       (SELECT string_agg(p.title, '  →  ' ORDER BY u.ord)
        FROM unnest(h.path) WITH ORDINALITY AS u(paper_id, ord)
        JOIN paper p ON p.paper_id = u.paper_id) AS chain
FROM hits h
WHERE h.depth = (SELECT min(depth) FROM hits)
LIMIT 3;
```

hops	chain
3	Loihi: A Neuromorphic Manycore Processor with On-Chip Learning → Even…
3	Loihi: A Neuromorphic Manycore Processor with On-Chip Learning → Even…
3	Loihi: A Neuromorphic Manycore Processor with On-Chip Learning → Even…

Plan: Limit · planning 0.07 ms · execution 0.94 ms · operators: Limit, Recursive Union, Result, Nested Loop, WorkTable Scan, Index Only Scan using pk_citation, CTE Scan, Aggregate, …

Analytics

Q20 · Papers by field and year with subtotals

Technique: GROUPING SETS with a grand total, GROUPING() to label subtotal rows · **runs as** `ra_anon` · `Q20_topic_year_rollup.sql`

```
SELECT CASE WHEN grouping(f.topic_name) = 1 THEN 'All fields' ELSE f.topic_name END AS field,
       CASE WHEN grouping(p.publication_year) = 1 THEN 'All years' ELSE p.publication_year::TEXT END AS year,
       count(DISTINCT p.paper_id) AS papers
FROM paper p
JOIN paper_topic pt ON pt.paper_id = p.paper_id AND pt.is_primary
JOIN topic t ON t.topic_id = pt.topic_id
JOIN topic sf ON sf.topic_id = t.parent_topic_id
JOIN topic f ON f.topic_id = sf.parent_topic_id
WHERE p.publication_date >= make_date(EXTRACT(YEAR FROM now())::INT - 5, 1, 1)
GROUP BY GROUPING SETS ((f.topic_name, p.publication_year), (f.topic_name), ())
ORDER BY grouping(f.topic_name), field, grouping(p.publication_year), year;
```

field	year	papers
Agricultural and Biological Sciences	2021	1
Agricultural and Biological Sciences	2022	2
Agricultural and Biological Sciences	2023	8
Agricultural and Biological Sciences	2024	6
Agricultural and Biological Sciences	2025	2

109 rows; the first 5 are shown.

Plan: Sort · planning 0.17 ms · execution 3.31 ms · operators: Sort, Aggregate, Hash Join, Index Scan using uq_one_primary_topic, Hash, Seq Scan on paper, Seq Scan on topic

11. Procedures, functions, triggers and CTEs (rubric 8)

Functions

Function	Returns	Technique	Used by	Tests
`app_current_user_id()`	bigint	`current_setting('app.user_id', true)`, `STABLE`	RLS policies, audit, procedures	`20_functions`
`fn_has_permission(user_id, code)`	boolean	four-table join, `SECURITY DEFINER`	procedures, UI gating	`20_functions`
`fn_topic_path(topic_id)`	text	recursive CTE up the tree, `string_agg … ORDER BY depth DESC`	breadcrumbs, `v_paper_card`	`20_functions`
`fn_topic_descendants(topic_id)`	table(topic_id, depth)	recursive CTE down the tree	topic pages, `fn_topic_growth`	`20_functions`
`fn_paper_lineage(paper_id, direction, max_depth)`	table(paper_id, depth, path)	recursive CTE with `SEARCH BREADTH FIRST` and `CYCLE`, `DISTINCT ON`	Lineage view, API	`20_functions`
`fn_author_h_index(author_id)`	int	`row_number()` window	author page, `mv_author_stats`	`20_functions`, `50_views`
`fn_search_papers(query, limit, offset)`	table(paper_id, title, rank, headline, matched_by)	`websearch_to_tsquery`, `ts_rank_cd`, `ts_headline`, trigram fallback	lexical search	`20_functions`
`fn_retraction_exposure(paper_id)`	table(retracted_paper_id, hops, path)	recursive CTE limited to 2 hops, joined to `retraction`	Integrity Radar	`20_functions`
`fn_topic_growth(topic_id, from, to)`	table(year, papers, yoy_pct)	`generate_series` fills empty years, `LAG()`	Research fronts, Q19	`20_functions`
`fn_ensure_audit_partition(ts)`	text	dynamic DDL with `format('%I', …)`	audit partitions	migration
`fn_user_display_names(ids)`	table(user_id, name)	narrow `SECURITY DEFINER` read past forced RLS: names only	trail and relation bylines	`60_rbac`
`fn_lab_side_effects()`	table(source, row_id, target, operation, detail)	rows whose `xmin` is the current transaction, with a changed-columns diff	Query Lab trigger demos	`40_triggers`

The lineage walk

```
WITH RECURSIVE walk(paper_id, depth, path) AS (
  SELECT c.cited_paper_id, 1, ARRAY[p_paper_id]
  FROM citation c WHERE c.citing_paper_id = p_paper_id
  UNION ALL
  SELECT c.cited_paper_id, w.depth + 1, w.path || w.paper_id
  FROM walk w JOIN citation c ON c.citing_paper_id = w.paper_id
  WHERE w.depth < least(p_max_depth, 6)
) SEARCH BREADTH FIRST BY paper_id SET bfs_order
  CYCLE paper_id SET is_cycle USING visit_path
SELECT DISTINCT ON (walk.paper_id) walk.paper_id, walk.depth, walk.path || walk.paper_id
FROM walk WHERE NOT walk.is_cycle AND walk.paper_id <> p_paper_id
ORDER BY walk.paper_id, walk.depth, walk.bfs_order;
```

Termination: the recursive term stops producing rows once `depth` reaches the limit; the `CYCLE` clause additionally marks a row whose `paper_id` already appears on its own path, so a citation loop cannot recurse forever. `SEARCH BREADTH FIRST` orders the rows level by level, and `DISTINCT ON` keeps each paper once, at the shallowest depth at which it was reached.

Authentication functions (SECURITY DEFINER)

`fn_auth_lookup`, `fn_session_user`, `fn_record_login_failure`, `fn_record_login_success`, `fn_session_extend` and `fn_session_delete` are the only way to read password hashes or touch `user_session`. They are owned by `ra_owner`, run with `SET search_path = pg_catalog, public` so a caller cannot shadow a table with one of their own, return only the columns the login flow needs, and are granted narrowly: the two readers to `ra_anon`, the writers only to `ra_app` itself (chapter 10).

Procedures

Procedure	What it does	Technique	Tests
`sp_register_user(name, email, hash, role_code, INOUT user_id)`	creates an account	custom SQLSTATE `RA001` for a duplicate email; only `users:manage` may create non-researchers	`30_procedures`
`sp_import_paper(payload, INOUT paper_id)`	upserts a whole OpenAlex work	`MERGE … RETURNING merge_action()`, data-modifying CTEs over `jsonb_to_recordset`, idempotent	`30_procedures` (3 fixtures)
`sp_retract_paper(paper_id, date, status, reason, url)`	records a retraction	`INSERT … ON CONFLICT DO UPDATE`; date-guard, audit and outbox triggers fire; `RAISE NOTICE` with exposure count	`30_procedures`, `60_rbac`
`sp_merge_authors(keep_id, dup_id)`	folds a duplicate author	`SELECT … FOR UPDATE` in id order (deadlock-safe), `DELETE … USING`	`30_procedures`
`sp_add_to_collection(collection_id, paper_id, priority)`	appends a paper	position = max + 1; ownership proven by RLS `WITH CHECK`	`30_procedures`
`sp_set_user_role(user_id, role_code)`	changes a role	permission check, then `trg_protect_last_admin`	`30_procedures`
`sp_refresh_analytics()`	refreshes both MVs	`REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW CONCURRENTLY` (needs the unique indexes)	`30_procedures`, `60_rbac`
`sp_purge_expired_sessions(INOUT deleted)`	deletes expired sessions	data-modifying CTE `DELETE … RETURNING` counted	`30_procedures`

Why `sp_merge_authors` cannot deadlock. Two administrators merging the same pair in opposite directions would, with naive locking, each lock one row and wait for the other. Locking both rows with `ORDER BY author_id FOR UPDATE` makes every caller acquire the locks in the same order, so the second caller simply waits for the first to finish.

Triggers

Trigger	Table · timing · level	Purpose	Tests
`trg_set_updated_at`	user_account, paper, collection, note · BEFORE UPDATE · row (with `WHEN (OLD IS DISTINCT FROM NEW)` where allowed)	keeps `updated_at` honest	`40_triggers`
`trg_retraction_date_guard`	retraction · BEFORE INSERT OR UPDATE OF retraction_date, paper_id · row	rejects a retraction dated before publication (23514) — a CHECK cannot read another table	`40_triggers`
`trg_topic_hierarchy_guard`	topic · BEFORE INSERT OR UPDATE OF parent_topic_id, topic_level · row	child level = parent level + 1; no cycles (recursive walk)	`40_triggers`
`trg_citation_count_ins/_del/_upd`	citation · AFTER · **statement**, with transition tables	one aggregated UPDATE per statement keeps `local_citation_count` exact	`40_triggers`
`trg_reading_status_read_at`	collection_paper · BEFORE INSERT OR UPDATE OF reading_status · row	sets or clears `read_at`	`40_triggers`
`trg_protect_last_admin`	user_account · BEFORE UPDATE OF role_id, is_active OR DELETE · row	never leaves zero active admins (`RA002`)	`40_triggers`, `30_procedures`
`trg_note_owner_immutable`	note · BEFORE UPDATE OF user_id, paper_id · row	a note cannot move to another user or paper	`40_triggers`
`trg_audit`	paper, retraction, user_account, role_permission, collection · AFTER I/U/D · row	writes `audit_log` with before/after images, minus `password_hash`	`40_triggers`
`trg_graph_outbox`	13 catalog tables · AFTER I/U/D · row	writes `graph_outbox` and `pg_notify('graph_outbox', id)`	`40_triggers`

Row-level versus statement-level

A row-level trigger runs once per affected row; a statement-level trigger runs once per statement. Loading 5,000 citations with one `INSERT … SELECT` would run a row-level counter 5,000 times, each an `UPDATE paper`. The statement-level version sees all inserted rows at once through the transition table `new_rows` and does a single grouped update:

```
CREATE TRIGGER trg_citation_count_ins AFTER INSERT ON citation
  REFERENCING NEW TABLE AS new_rows FOR EACH STATEMENT EXECUTE FUNCTION fn_citation_count_ins();

UPDATE paper p SET local_citation_count = p.local_citation_count + d.n
FROM (SELECT cited_paper_id, count(*) AS n FROM new_rows GROUP BY cited_paper_id) d
WHERE p.paper_id = d.cited_paper_id;
```

`40_triggers.sql` asserts that after inserts, deletes and an update, every stored count equals the real count.

The outbox and why there are no dual writes

If the web app wrote to PostgreSQL and then to Neo4j, a crash between the two writes would leave them inconsistent. Instead the triggers write an outbox row **in the same transaction** as the change; if the transaction rolls back, so does the outbox row. A worker (`pnpm graph:sync`) replays pending rows into Neo4j with idempotent `MERGE` statements and marks them processed (chapter 9).

Views and materialized views

View	Kind	Notes
`v_paper_card`	view, `security_invoker`	paper + venue + ordered author list (`LATERAL` + `string_agg … ORDER BY author_order`) + primary topic path + retraction status
`v_retraction_exposure`	view, `security_invoker`, recursive	papers citing retracted work within two hops
`v_my_library`	view, `security_invoker`	caller's collections with counts per reading status via `count(*) FILTER (…)`
`mv_topic_year_stats`	materialized	papers, citations and open-access share per topic and year over each topic's subtree (recursive closure); unique index for concurrent refresh
`mv_author_stats`	materialized	papers, citations, h-index, first and last year per author

View versus materialized view. A view is a stored query, recomputed on every read, so it is always current. A materialized view stores its result; reads are fast but the data is as old as the last refresh. `REFRESH MATERIALIZED VIEW CONCURRENTLY` rebuilds it without locking out readers by computing the new result and applying the difference row by row — which needs a unique index to match old and new rows.

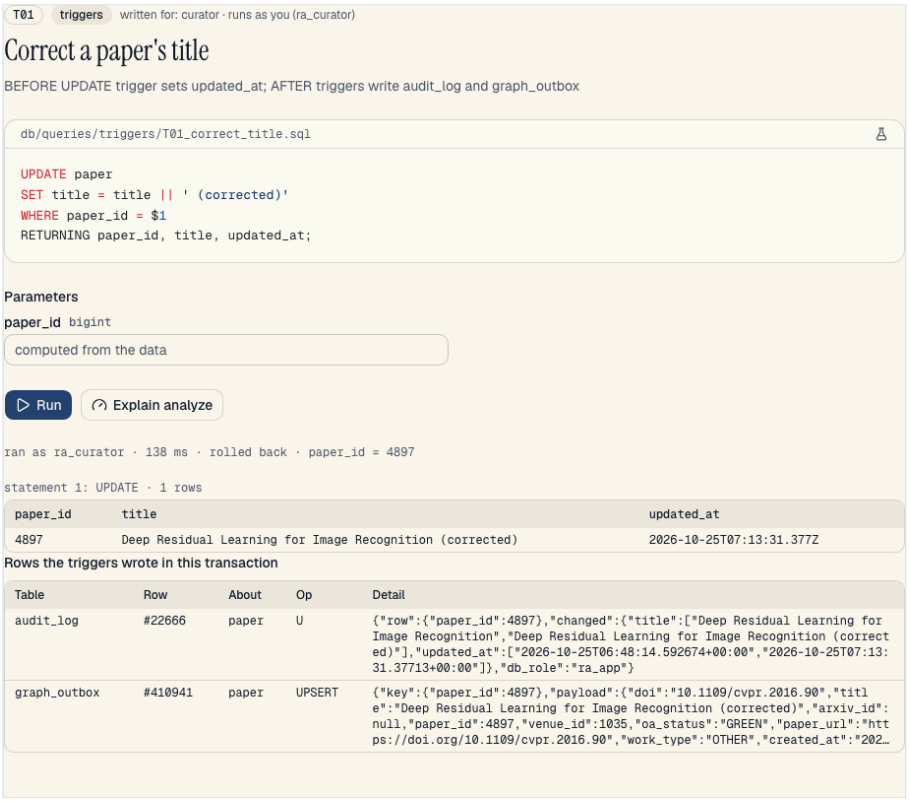
`security_invoker`**.** By default a view runs with its owner's privileges, so row-level security on the underlying tables would be evaluated for `ra_owner` (who bypasses it). `security_invoker = true` makes PostgreSQL evaluate permissions and policies for the caller, so `v_my_library` returns different rows for different users.

CTE patterns used

Pattern	Where
Recursive CTE down a tree	`fn_topic_descendants`, Q14
Recursive CTE up a tree	`fn_topic_path`, `trg_topic_hierarchy_guard`
Recursive CTE over a graph with `SEARCH` / `CYCLE`	`fn_paper_lineage`, Q15
Breadth-first shortest path with a path array	Q16
Recursive transitive closure	`mv_topic_year_stats`
Data-modifying CTE (`DELETE … RETURNING` counted)	`sp_purge_expired_sessions`, `fn_session_delete`
Non-recursive CTE chains for readability	Q03, `fn_topic_growth`

Triggers at work

Correcting a paper's title in the Query Lab (demo T01, as a curator). Below the result are the `audit_log` and `graph_outbox` rows the triggers wrote in the same transaction, which was then rolled back.



12. NoSQL and vector features with read, update and delete (rubric 9)

Vector search

Each paper is embedded with Ollama's `embeddinggemma` (768 dimensions) using the model's document prompt, `title: {title} | text: {abstract}`; a search query uses `task: search result | query: {q}`. Vectors are cached on disk by a hash of the text, so re-running `pnpm embed:papers` only embeds what changed (5,761 papers took 106 s on the laptop's GPU). A Transformers.js build of the same model is the fallback provider; its vectors agree with Ollama's at cosine 0.996.

Similar papers (catalog query C02):

```
CYPHER 25
MATCH (seed:Paper {paperId: $paper_id})
MATCH (p:Paper)
  SEARCH p IN (VECTOR INDEX paper_embedding FOR seed.embedding WHERE p.year >= 2020 LIMIT 11) SCORE AS score
WITH seed, p, score WHERE p <> seed
RETURN p.paperId AS paperId, p.title AS title, p.year AS year, round(score, 3) AS score
ORDER BY score DESC LIMIT 10
```

Hybrid search runs PostgreSQL full-text search and the vector search side by side and fuses the two rankings with Reciprocal Rank Fusion, score = Σ 1 / (60 + rank). The search page shows each hit's rank in both lists.

Probe results

The five probe queries from the plan, top five hits each (`pnpm embed:papers --probe`):

Query	Top hits (cosine similarity)
spiking neurons energy efficiency	0.819 Spike-based dynamic computing with asynchronous sensing-computing neuromorphic chip · 0.811 Accurate and efficient time-domain classification with adaptive spiking recurrent neural networks · 0.809 High-performance deep spiking neural networks with 0.3 spikes per neuron · 0.808 Spiking Neural Networks and Their Applications: A Review · 0.802 A 4-fJ/Spike Artificial Neuron in 65 nm CMOS Technology

Query	Top hits (cosine similarity)
retrieval augmented generation	0.823 Retrieval-Augmented Generation for AI-Generated Content: A Survey · 0.805 Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Large Language Models: A Survey · 0.800 Retrieval-augmented generation for educational application · 0.787 Hallucination Mitigation for Retrieval-Augmented LLMs · 0.782 Graph Retrieval-Augmented Generation: A Survey
graph attention	0.816 Attention-based Graph Neural Network for Semi-supervised Learning · 0.815 Understanding Attention and Generalization in GNNs · 0.813 Graph Attention Networks · 0.812 How to Find Your Friendly Neighborhood · 0.807 How Attentive are Graph Attention Networks?
ICU mortality prediction	0.837 Prediction model of in-hospital mortality in ICU patients with heart failure · 0.830 Predicting Mortality in ICU Patients With Heart Failure · 0.827 Dynamic and explainable ML prediction of mortality in ICU patients · 0.821 Prognostic Assessment of COVID-19 in the ICU · 0.811 Using ML to Predict ICU Transfer in COVID-19 Patients
offline reinforcement learning	0.877 Offline RL: Tutorial, Review, and Perspectives on Open Problems · 0.861 A Survey on Offline RL · 0.834 Conservative Q-Learning for Offline RL · 0.825 Off-Policy Deep RL without Exploration · 0.824 MOPO: Model-based Offline Policy Optimization

Every hit is on topic, including papers whose titles share no words with the query.

Graph algorithms (`pnpm graph:analytics`)

Job	Algorithm (GDS)	Written to	Used by
Influence	ArticleRank on the citation graph	`Paper.articleRank`	Hidden gems (influential but under-cited), ranking
Research fronts	Leiden on the undirected citation graph, fixed seed: 125 communities, modularity 0.62	`Paper.community`	Atlas colours, Research fronts page
Brokers	Betweenness centrality (sampled)	`Paper.betweenness`	Bridges query (C08)
Co-authorship	Cypher aggregation over shared papers	`COAUTHOR {papers}`	Author network, “people you may collaborate with” (C05)
Semantic neighbours	Top 10 vector neighbours, score ≥ 0.75	`SIMILAR_TO {score, model}`	Similar tab on paper pages

`pnpm layout:umap` projects the embeddings to two dimensions with a seeded UMAP, so the map is identical on every rebuild.

Read, update and delete on graph-native data

Neo4j Community has no fine-grained access control, so ownership is enforced in the Cypher itself: the creator may change a relation or trail, and so may a curator (relations) or an administrator (trails). Every path is covered by integration tests in `tests/integration/graph-native.test.ts`.

Curated relations

Operation	API	Cypher idea
Create	`POST /api/v1/papers/{id}/relations`	`MATCH` both papers, `CREATE (a)-[:EXTENDS {relationId: $id, …}]->(b)` with a UUID made by the server
Read	`GET /api/v1/papers/{id}/relations`, `GET /api/v1/relations/{id}`	match by `relationId`, either direction
Update	`PATCH /api/v1/relations/{id}`	note and confidence in place; a type change recreates the relationship with the same id (Cypher cannot retype one)
Delete	`DELETE /api/v1/relations/{id}`	`WHERE r.createdBy = $userId OR $isCurator … DELETE r`

Update in place (catalog query C11):

```
MATCH (:Paper)-[r {relationId: $relation_id}]->(:Paper)
WHERE r.createdBy = $user_id OR $is_curator
SET r.note = 'Confirmed after reading section 4', r.confidence = 5, r.updatedAt = datetime()
RETURN r.relationId AS relationId, type(r) AS relation, r.note AS note, r.confidence AS confidence
```

Reading trails

A trail is a `Trail` node with ordered `STEP {position, annotation}` relationships to papers.

Operation	API	Notes
Create	`POST /api/v1/trails`, `POST /api/v1/trails/{id}/steps`	positions assigned in order
Read	`GET /api/v1/trails`, `GET /api/v1/trails/{id}`	private trails are invisible (404, not 403) to others
Update	`PATCH /api/v1/trails/{id}` (title, visibility), `PATCH …/steps/{position}` (annotation), reorder	reorder rewrites all positions in one transaction and rejects an order that is not a permutation
Delete	`DELETE …/steps/{position}`, `DELETE /api/v1/trails/{id}`	removing a step closes the gap

Remove step 2 and close the gap (C12):

```
MATCH (t:Trail {trailId: $trail_id})-[s:STEP {position: 2}]->()
DELETE s
WITH t
MATCH (t)-[rest:STEP]->(p:Paper) WHERE rest.position > 2
SET rest.position = rest.position - 1
```

The same question in both databases

The Lineage and Connect pages answer each question twice and show both timings:

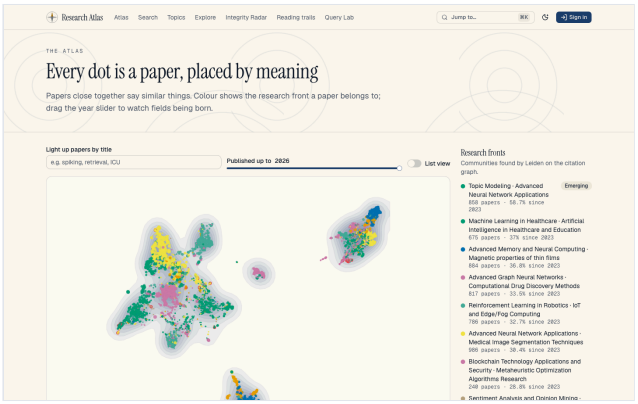
Question	PostgreSQL	Neo4j
What does this paper build on, 3 levels deep?	recursive CTE with `SEARCH BREADTH FIRST` and `CYCLE` (`fn_paper_lineage`), 300 papers in 76 ms	variable-length `(p)-[:CITES]->{1,3}(q)`, 128 ms
Shortest citation chain between two papers	breadth-first recursive CTE carrying the path as an array (Q16)	`SHORTEST 1 (a)-[:CITES]-+(b)` (C03)

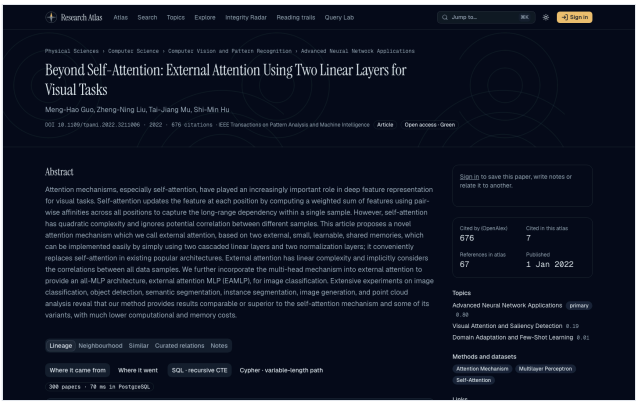
At this size PostgreSQL is competitive on traversals; Neo4j earns its place with the vector index, the graph algorithms and the graph-native features, which would be awkward or impossible in SQL alone.

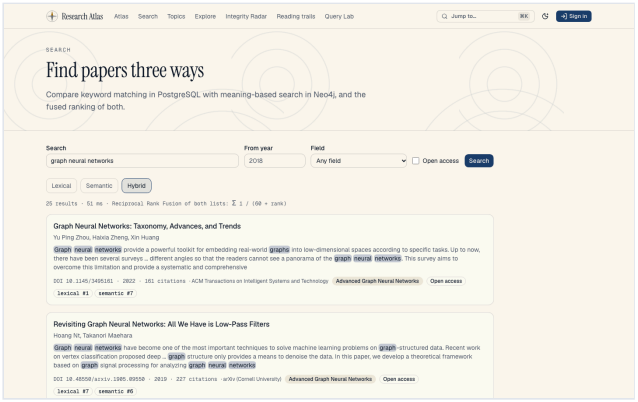
13. Application and API (rubrics 10 and 11)

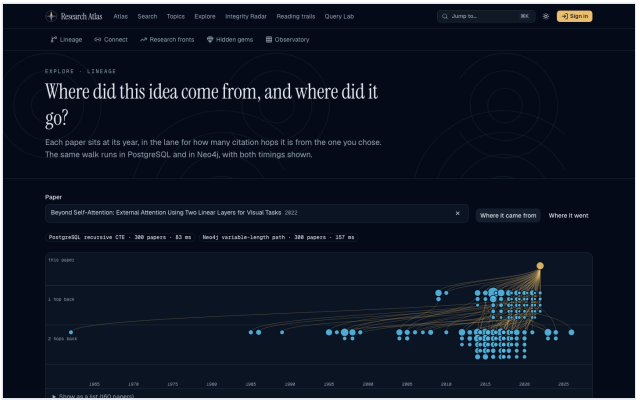
The application has 22 pages, works in a dark and a light theme, is usable by keyboard, and passes axe-core's WCAG 2.2 AA checks on every page in both themes. Lighthouse scores it 92–100 for performance and 100 for accessibility.

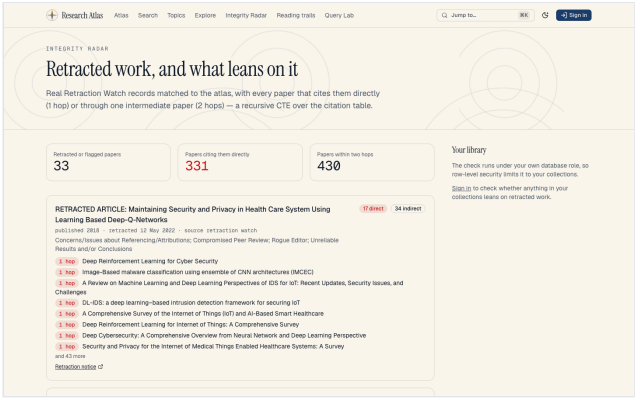
Figures, left to right and top to bottom: the atlas; a paper page; search; the lineage timeline; the Integrity Radar; the library board; the curation workbench; the admin console.

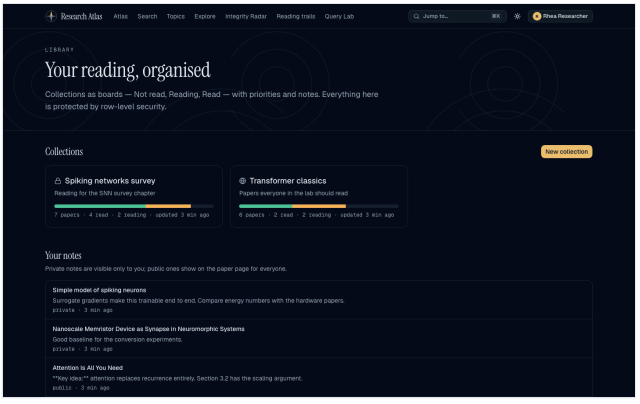

Research Atlas
Every dot is a paper, placed by meaning
Papers close together say similar things. Colour shows the research front a paper belongs to; drag the year slider to watch fields being born.

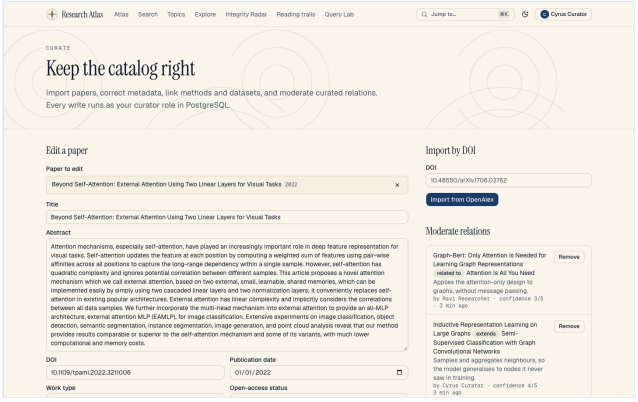

Research Atlas
Beyond Self-Attention: External Attention Using Two Linear Layers for Visual Tasks
Abstract

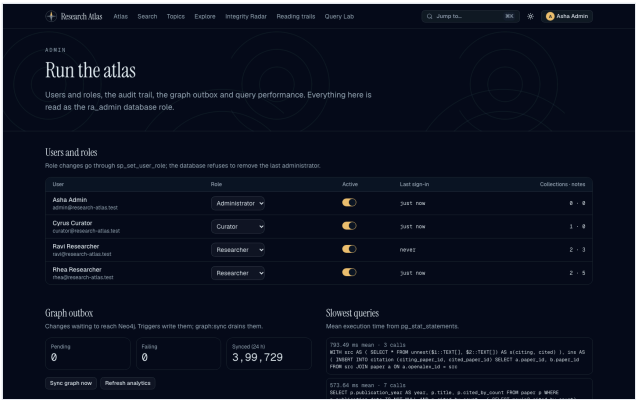

Research Atlas
Find papers three ways
Compare keyword matching in PostgreSQL with meaning-based search in Neo4j, and the fused ranking of both.


Research Atlas
Where did this idea come from, and where did it go?
Each paper sits at its year, in the lane for how many citation hops it is from the one you chose. The same walk runs in PostgreSQL and in Neo4j, with both timings shown.


Research Atlas
Retracted work, and what leans on it
Real Retraction Watch records matched to the atlas, with every paper that cites them directly (1 hop) or through one intermediate paper (2 hops) — a recursive CTE over the citation table.


Research Atlas
Your reading, organised
Collections as boards — Not read, Reading, Read — with priorities and notes. Everything here is protected by row-level security.


Research Atlas
Keep the catalog right
Import papers, correct metadata, link methods and datasets, and moderate curated relations. Every write runs as your curator role in PostgreSQL.


Research Atlas
Run the atlas
Users and roles, the audit trail, the graph outbox and query performance. Everything here is read as the ra_admin database role.



One registry, four uses

Every endpoint is one entry in `src/server/api/registry.ts`: its summary, tag, minimum role, and the Zod schemas for its query string and body. That single entry drives

1. **validation** of every request (Zod 4);
2. **the role gate**, before any database work;
3. **the OpenAPI document**, generated from the same Zod schemas with `z.toJSONSchema`;
4. **the role-matrix test**, which calls every endpoint as every role (264 cases) and checks the status.

Route files are one line each; the shared wrapper `route()` in `src/server/api/handler.ts` does the rest.

Conventions

Aspect	Convention
Authentication	the `ra_session` cookie set by `POST /auth/login` or `/auth/signup`
Cross-site protection	non-GET requests must carry a same-origin `Origin` header, else 403
Status codes	200 read, 201 created, 204 deleted, 401 not signed in, 403 role too low or refused by PostgreSQL, 404 missing, 409 conflict, 422 invalid input or broken rule
Errors	`application/problem+json` (RFC 9457) with `type`, `title`, `status`, `detail`, and for database rules `constraint` and `sqlstate`
Database access	every handler runs inside one transaction under the caller's PostgreSQL role (chapter 10)
Graph consistency	handlers that change projected data drain the outbox into Neo4j before answering
Caching	anonymous catalog reads are cached and invalidated by tag after any write

Database errors become readable problems

`src/server/db/errors.ts` maps SQLSTATEs to HTTP and names the broken rule in plain words:

SQLSTATE	HTTP	Title
23505 unique violation	409	Already exists

SQLSTATE	HTTP	Title
23001 restrict violation	409	Still in use
23503 foreign key violation	422	Refers to something that does not exist
23514 check violation (and trigger guards)	422	Breaks a data rule
23502 not-null violation	422	A required value is missing
42501 insufficient privilege	403	Not allowed
RA001 (custom)	409	Email already registered
RA002 (custom)	409	The last administrator cannot be removed

For example, a curator gives a paper a DOI that another paper already has:

```
PATCH /api/v1/papers/952
Content-Type: application/json

{"doi": "10.1145/3495161"}
```

```
{
  "type": "https://research-atlas.test/problems/sqlstate-23505",
  "title": "Already exists",
  "status": 409,
  "detail": "Another paper already has this DOI.",
  "constraint": "uq_paper_doi",
  "sqlstate": "23505"
}
```

Constraints without a plain-language explanation return PostgreSQL's own message, which always names the constraint, because every constraint has a name.

14. Authentication and RBAC in the database (rubric 12)

Accounts and passwords

- **Sign-up** calls the procedure `sp_register_user`, which validates the email, refuses duplicates with a named error (SQLSTATE `RA001`) and assigns the researcher role.
- **Passwords** are hashed with **Argon2id** (`@node-rs/argon2`, memory 19 MiB, 2 iterations, parallelism 1: the OWASP minimum). `chk_user_account_password_is_argon2id` refuses anything that is not an Argon2id PHC string, so a plaintext password cannot be stored even by mistake (constraint proof P04).
- **Lockout.** Five failed sign-ins in a row lock the account for fifteen minutes, even for the right password (`fn_record_login_failure`). The error message does not reveal whether the email exists.

Sessions

Sessions follow the Copenhagen Book design:

Aspect	Design
Token	256 random bits, base64url, sent only as the `ra_session` cookie
Storage	the database stores **SHA-256 of the token** as the session id; a leaked session table cannot be replayed
Cookie	`HttpOnly`, `SameSite=Lax`, `Path=/`, `Secure` in production, 30-day expiry
Renewal	extended to 30 days whenever fewer than 15 remain
Sign out	deletes this session, or every session of the user (“sign out everywhere”)
Cross-site writes	every non-GET API call must come from the same origin, or it gets 403

`user_session` has forced row-level security, **no policies and no grants**. Only six `SECURITY DEFINER` functions owned by `ra_owner` (`fn_auth_lookup`, `fn_session_user`, `fn_record_login_success`, `fn_record_login_failure`, `fn_session_extend`, `fn_session_delete`) can touch it, and only the connection role `ra_app` may call the session-writing ones, after it has verified the

password itself.

The role ladder

PostgreSQL role	Login	Inherits	Application role
`ra_owner`	no	—	owns every object, `BYPASSRLS`; used only by migrations and `SECURITY DEFINER` functions
`ra_app`	**yes**	`NOINHERIT`	the web server's connection; no data privileges of its own
`ra_anon`	no	—	visitors
`ra_researcher`	no	`ra_anon`	signed-up users
`ra_curator`	no	`ra_researcher`	curators
`ra_admin`	no	`ra_curator`	administrators

Because `ra_app` is `NOINHERIT`, it holds no privileges until a request switches to one of the four group roles.

Privilege matrix

Object	anon	researcher	curator	admin
Catalog tables (paper, author, citation, topic, …)	SELECT	SELECT	+ INSERT, UPDATE	+ DELETE
Link tables (paper_author, citation, paper_topic, paper_method, paper_dataset, resource)	SELECT	SELECT	+ INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE	same
`retraction`	SELECT	SELECT	SELECT	+ INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE
`collection`, `collection_paper`, `note`	SELECT (public rows)	+ INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE (own rows)	same	all rows
`user_account`	—	SELECT own row (no password columns), UPDATE own name	same	SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE
`role_permission`	SELECT	SELECT	SELECT	+ INSERT, DELETE
`audit_log`	—	—	—	SELECT
`graph_outbox`	—	—	—	SELECT, UPDATE
Materialized views	SELECT	SELECT	SELECT	+ MAINTAIN (refresh)
`sp_add_to_collection`	—	EXECUTE	EXECUTE	EXECUTE
`sp_import_paper`	—	—	EXECUTE	EXECUTE
`sp_retract_paper`, `sp_merge_authors`, `sp_set_user_role`, `sp_refresh_analytics`, `sp_purge_expired_sessions`	—	—	—	EXECUTE

Nothing is executable by `PUBLIC`; every grant in `300_rbac.sql` is deliberate. The application's permission vocabulary lives in the `permission` and `role_permission` tables (`papers:write`, `relations:moderate`, `lab:dml`, …) and drives what the interface shows.

Row-level security

Five tables have **forced** row-level security, so even the table owner is filtered (only `ra_owner`, with `BYPASSRLS`, and its `SECURITY DEFINER` functions see every row):

Table	Policy	Applies to	Rule
`note`	`note_public_read`	anon (and every role above it)	`SELECT` where `NOT is_private`
	`note_owner_all`	researcher	all commands where `user_id = app_current_user_id()`, checked on write too
	`note_admin_all`	admin	everything

Table	Policy	Applies to	Rule
`collection`	`collection_public_read` / `collection_owner_all` / `collection_admin_all`	as above	`is_public` / owner / everything
`collection_paper`	`…_public_read` / `…_owner_all` / `…_admin_all`	as above	an entry follows its collection, through an `EXISTS` that is itself filtered by the collection policies
`user_account`	`user_account_self` / `user_account_admin_all`	researcher / admin	own row / everything
`user_session`	none	—	unreachable except through the auth functions

Views that read these tables (`v_my_library`, `v_paper_card`, `v_retraction_exposure`) use `security_invoker`, so the policies are evaluated for the caller, not the view owner.

Proof in psql

The same rules, seen directly in `psql` as the database superuser switching roles. Rhea is a researcher with five notes; Ravi is another researcher.

```
BEGIN;
BEGIN
SET LOCAL ROLE ra_anon;
SET
SELECT count(*) AS public_notes FROM note;
 public_notes
--------------
            2
(1 row)

SELECT count(*) FROM user_account;
ERROR:  permission denied for table user_account
ROLLBACK;
ROLLBACK
BEGIN;
BEGIN
SELECT set_config('app.user_id', (SELECT user_id::TEXT FROM user_account WHERE email = 'rhea@research-atlas.test'),
true) AS acting_as;
 acting_as
-----------
 3
(1 row)

SET LOCAL ROLE ra_researcher;
SET
SELECT count(*) AS visible_notes, count(*) FILTER (WHERE user_id = app_current_user_id()) AS mine FROM note;
 visible_notes | mine
---------------+------
             6 |    5
(1 row)

INSERT INTO note (user_id, paper_id, note_text) VALUES (4, 1, 'written in Ravi''s name');
ERROR:  new row violates row-level security policy for table "note"
INSERT INTO retraction (paper_id, retraction_date, status) VALUES (1, CURRENT_DATE, 'RETRACTED');
ERROR:  permission denied for table retraction
ROLLBACK;
ROLLBACK
BEGIN;
BEGIN
SET LOCAL ROLE ra_admin;
SET
SELECT count(*) AS all_notes FROM note;
 all_notes
-----------
         8
(1 row)

ROLLBACK;
ROLLBACK
```

As anonymous, two public notes are visible and accounts are off limits. As Rhea, she sees her five notes and one public note of someone else; writing a note in Ravi's name violates the policy's `WITH CHECK`; and recording a retraction is not granted to researchers at all. The administrator sees all eight notes. The same cases run as pgTAP tests in `db/tests/60_rbac.sql`, and the Query Lab shows them live: run proof P09 or P10 as a researcher.

15. Testing

What is tested where

Layer	Tool	What it proves	Count	Command
Constraints	pgTAP	each named constraint accepts valid rows and refuses invalid ones; a meta-test fails if a constraint has no test	163	`pnpm db:test`
Functions and procedures	pgTAP	known answers on a hand-built seed (h-index, lineage depth, topic path, exposure hops), error codes	in the 361	`pnpm db:test`
Triggers	pgTAP	derived columns, guards, audit rows, outbox rows, side-effect reader	in the 361	`pnpm db:test`
Views	pgTAP	`security_invoker` behaviour, materialized view contents	in the 361	`pnpm db:test`
RBAC and RLS	pgTAP with `SET ROLE`	allowed actions succeed, forbidden ones raise 42501, other users' rows are invisible	in the 361	`pnpm db:test`
Migrations	dbmate	a fresh database rolls back to zero and migrates up again	16 migrations	`pnpm verify:all`
SQL catalog	Node runner	all 55 files run as their role; read queries return rows on the real corpus; proofs fail with the constraint they name	55	`pnpm queries:run`
Cypher catalog	Node runner	all 12 files run and return rows (writes rolled back)	12	`pnpm cypher:run`
Graph consistency	`graph:check`	17 counts match between PostgreSQL and Neo4j, derived co-authorship included	17	`pnpm graph:check`
Units	Vitest	password hashing, session tokens, RRF fusion, SQLSTATE mapping, Zod schemas, the arXiv date rule		`pnpm test`
API	Vitest	every endpoint × every role (264 cases), lockout, cookie flags, cross-site refusal, `/api/docs`		`pnpm test`
Graph services	Vitest + Neo4j	every read, update and delete path of relations and trails, ownership refusals, incremental co-author sync		`pnpm test`
Query Lab	Vitest	role-scoped runs, plans, proofs, NOTICE capture, side effects, rollback, commit refusal		`pnpm test`
Pages	Playwright	every page renders for the right role with no console errors; wrong roles get 403 or a sign-in redirect	22 pages	`pnpm test:e2e`
Interactions	Playwright	Query Lab runs, command palette search		`pnpm test:e2e`
Accessibility	axe-core in Playwright	no serious or critical WCAG 2.2 AA violation on any page, dark and light	44 scans	`pnpm test:e2e`
Performance	Lighthouse	performance, accessibility, best practices and SEO ≥ 90 on home and a paper page, mobile and desktop	16 scores	`pnpm perf:lighthouse`

Vitest totals 327 tests in 9 files; Playwright runs 67 tests.

Latest `pnpm verify:all`

Run on 25 October 2026 on the development machine:

```
verify:all: all 15 steps passed in 98 s
  ok     0.1 s  lint
  ok     1.3 s  typecheck
  ok     0.2 s  db:migrate
  ok     1.3 s  migrations: fresh test database, roll back to zero, migrate up again
  ok     1.1 s  db:test (test database rebuilt from zero, seeded, pgTAP)
  ok     0.3 s  queries:run --test
  ok     2.0 s  queries:run --require-rows
  ok     5.6 s  graph:rebuild
  ok     0.3 s  graph:check
  ok     0.4 s  cypher:run --require-rows
  ok     4.1 s  test
  ok     4.1 s  build
  ok     0.6 s  next start on port 3101
  ok    49.2 s  test:e2e
  ok    27.2 s  perf:lighthouse --base http://localhost:3101
```

Lighthouse scores from the same run (production build, local server):

```
ok   mobile  /             performance 92  accessibility 100  best-practices 100  seo 100   LCP 3.4 s  TBT 20 ms  CLS 0
ok   mobile  /papers/952    performance 94  accessibility 100  best-practices 100  seo 90   LCP 3.1 s  TBT 10 ms  CLS 0
ok   desktop /             performance 100  accessibility 100  best-practices 100  seo 100   LCP 0.7 s  TBT 0 ms  CLS 0
ok   desktop /papers/952    performance 100  accessibility 100  best-practices 100  seo 90   LCP 0.7 s  TBT 0 ms  CLS 0
```

16. Git workflow and contributions (rubrics 13 and 14)

Workflow

- One repository on GitHub; work is committed in small steps with Conventional Commit messages (`feat(db): …`, `test(rbac): …`, `docs: …`) and pushed to `main`.
- Every push runs the CI workflow: lint, type check and production build, plus a database job that migrates from zero and back, runs all pgTAP suites and the SQL catalog.
- Secrets never enter the repository: `.env.local` is ignored and `.env.example` holds placeholders.
- Generated artefacts (schema docs, the ER export, chapters 5–7, this report) are produced by scripts, so they always match the code.

History

40 commits between 2026-10-25 and 2026-10-25, every one on `main` and pushed to GitHub, each checked by the CI workflow.

Author	Commits
Daruru Bhuvan Sai	40

Commit type	Count
`feat`	16
`docs`	8
`chore`	4
`build`	3
`fix`	3
`test`	3
`refactor`	1
`ci`	1
`perf`	1

Ownership

Area	Daruru Bhuvan Sai	Deeptanshu Kumar
Owns and presents	ER model, relational schema, constraints, normalization, advanced SQL, RBAC and row-level security, authentication	Neo4j model, outbox sync, embeddings and vector search, graph algorithms, graph-native features, explore pages, Query Lab
Report chapters	2–6, 9–11, 14	7, 8, 12, 13, 15

Originality

- **The Query Lab**: every catalog file runs live as the visitor's own database role, with an `EXPLAIN ANALYZE` or `PROFILE` plan tree, captured `NOTICE`s, and the audit and outbox rows the run's triggers wrote — read back through a narrow `SECURITY DEFINER` function that only sees the caller's own transaction.
- **The same question in both databases**, side by side with timings (lineage, shortest path).
- **Integrity Radar**: retracted work and everything within two citation hops, including a check of the user's own library under row-level security.
- **Hidden gems and research fronts** from ArticleRank and Leiden over the real citation graph.

17. Conclusion and future work

Research Atlas meets every rubric row with working, tested code: the database enforces its own integrity and access rules; the graph store adds traversal, vector search and algorithms without compromising consistency; and the application makes both visible, down to query plans and trigger side effects.

Future work:

1. **Continuous sync**: a long-running worker that `LISTEN`s on the `graph_outbox` channel instead of draining after each write.
2. **Larger corpus**: the pipeline is incremental and cached; the main limits are the OpenAlex allowance and embedding time.
3. **PostgreSQL 19's SQL/PGQ**, when it ships, to compare property-graph queries inside PostgreSQL with Neo4j on the same data.
4. **Citation-context relations**: suggest curated relations from the sentences around each citation.

18. Appendix: changes from the proposal

#	In the proposal	In the final design
1	Citations only described in prose; no recursive SQL possible	`citation` table (self-referencing M:N) with `chk_no_self_citation`; lineage, paths and exposure as recursive CTEs
2	`citation_count` in the spec but not the DDL	`cited_by_count` (from OpenAlex) and trigger-maintained `local_citation_count`
3	`INT` keys, nothing generated	`BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY`; `uuidv7()` public ids where URLs are shared
4	Topic names unique globally	unique within the parent (`UNIQUE NULLS NOT DISTINCT`)
5	Self-parent blocked, cycles not	trigger walks ancestors and refuses cycles and level inversions
6	“Retraction after publication” stated, not enforced	`trg_retraction_date_guard`
7	RBAC was one `role` table	`role`, `permission`, `role_permission` plus PostgreSQL roles, GRANTs and forced row-level security
8	Case-sensitive email uniqueness	`email CITEXT UNIQUE`
9	Foreign keys without indexes	every foreign key indexed
10	DDL only as screenshots of typed commands	versioned migrations with up and down; snapshots regenerated from them
11	ER mixed notations and omitted CITES	pure Chen notation with CITES and SUBTOPIC_OF as recursive relationships
12	Graph relationships listed, no NoSQL implementation	Neo4j knowledge graph with vector index, outbox sync, graph algorithms and graph-native features
13	No normalization argument	functional dependencies and a BCNF check per table, two documented denormalizations